



DEEP BLUE SEA
A photo from
Vashist's dive,
showing the
marine diversity
of the Andamans



WATERWORLD A photo taken by Vashist
during a dive, showing his passion for
marine life



him tranquility, and has allowed his mind to be calm. "Each dive rejuvenates my spirit and reminds me of the profound connection we share with the ocean," he says.

Reflecting on his inaugural scuba diving adventure, Vashist reminisces how the crystalline waters and kaleidoscopic marine inhabitants together made the experience captivating, thereby cementing his ardour for diving.

In fact, with experiences spanning both Indian and foreign waters, Vashist's dives provide distinct vantage points and interactions with marine life. Although each dive possesses its own allure, for Vashist, excursions to the Andamans are of special value. "The sheer variety of marine creatures, set against pristine underwater vistas, delivers an unparalleled experience that never fails to leave me awestruck."

However, embarking on a diving adventure isn't without its hurdles. Like any thrilling pursuit, diving presents its own set of challenges, some of which even Vashist has encountered. "I've faced situations such as strong currents and limited visibility, but with proper training and experience, I've learnt to remain composed and adapt to safely overcome these obstacles."

Even for seasoned scuba divers like Vashist, staying informed about the latest diving techniques and safety measures is paramount. Therefore, he stays abreast of developments through reputable diving organisations, online resources, and participation in advanced training courses whenever feasible.

When asked for advice by those apprehensive about their inaugural dive, Vashist offers a reassuring response: "Place your trust in the expertise of your instructors, concentrate on your breathing, and tackle each moment as it arises. Remember, the underwater realm is tranquil and enchanting, and with the right mindset, your first dive can be a transformative experience."

For individuals inspired by Vashist's journey to pursue diving certification, he emphasises the importance of selecting a reputable diving school with experienced instructors who prioritise safety and offer comprehensive training. "Take your time to learn and master the essential skills, and embrace the journey towards becoming a certified diver." **BT**